

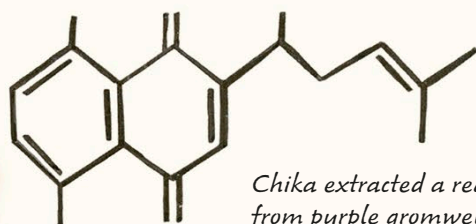


CHIKA KURODA

Japanese chemist
1884–1968

Nature is a feast of colors, from purple snails and orange flowers, to green leaves and yellow bananas. Chika Kuroda wondered what makes everything so colorful—and she spent her life finding out. At first, she worked as a teacher, but as she learned more about science, Chika became fascinated by the way chemistry could unlock the secrets of nature.

In 1913, Japan's brand-new Tohoku University accepted the country's first three female university students, including Chika. It was out of the ordinary at the time, but Chika showed that women could be brilliant scientists just like men, and she became the first Japanese woman to earn a science degree.



Chika extracted a red pigment from purple gromwell and named it shikonin. She figured out what atoms shikonin was made from, and how they fit together.

